Community in the Economy Policy

The Green Party will actively support resilient regional economic development, including through infrastructure development and procurement. We will remove barriers to local economies and encourage new, sustainable local industries. We will take a Tiriti-based approach to the tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector, focusing on strengthening government and business relationships with the sector, improving funding and accountability, and maintaining its independence.

Vision

Community wellbeing and local ecosystems are enhanced by resilient local economies and a strong, independent tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector.

Values and Principles

Policy decisions that impact community economic development must be consistent with the following values and principles:

- *Honour Te Tiriti o Waitangi*: Local hapū and iwi should lead the development of local economies.
- *Ecological Wisdom*: Local economic activity should have an enduring, net-restorative outcome for local ecosystems.
- *Social Responsibility*: Local economies should equitably serve their communities and enhance community wellbeing.
- *Appropriate Decision-Making*: Communities should be empowered to shape their economies.
- *Non-Violence*: Local economic activity should be equitably supported to address historic and current systemic oppression.
- *Risk-taking and Innovation*: Community economies and organisations should be recognised and cherished for exploring the cutting edge of our social, political, economic and environmental development.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

> *"...thriving neighbourhoods will be available to everyone.*
>
> *"Meaningful work will be available and people will have sufficient time to enjoy and participate in their communities.*
>
> *"All people will be empowered to shape the systems that affect them..."*

Actions in this policy that will help achieve this include:

- Providing flexible funding, advice, and partnerships to support community-led approaches to community development, resilience, and revitalisation; (1.2.2)
- Funding initiatives that keep local resources circulating locally, increase economic diversity, and minimise dependence on fossil fuels. (1.3.1)
- Undertaking adaptive community economic planning and mapping processes to proactively manage predicted changes in population, climate, energy, and the wider economy. (1.3.2)
- Enabling local currencies, community banks, credit unions, time banking schemes, and other local alternative economic systems (1.3.6)
- Ensuring Māori maintain ownership over taonga created by Māori within tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector organisations, including intellectual property, regardless of Government funding. (2.1.5)
- Enhance tangata whenua, community, and voluntary sector participation in policy and planning processes at all levels of Government (2.3)

Connected Policies

The Government in the Economy plays an important role in enabling Business to better support wider community vitality and resilience. Local economies are supported by infrastructure for Transport, Digital and communications technology, and Energy. Our Housing and Sustainable Communities Policy supports mixed-use zones for compact, walkable communities in which all basic needs can be met. Local economies are also affected by Global Affairs, including Climate Change.

Policy Positions

1. Regional and Community Economic Development

Issues

Many communities are dependent upon large businesses operated by and for national or overseas interests and the product and profit from their work is not kept within their community. Local economies are vulnerable to changes within the national and global economy, and need to be more diverse, community-led and ecologically sustainable to support community resilience.

Actions

1.1. Support community-led development that:

1.1.1. Reflects the unique aspirations, diversity, and strengths of the community

1.1.2. Nurtures diverse local leadership, builds intentional relationships, and actively engages marginalised groups

1.1.3. Encourages experimentation, adaptation, and reflection to drive continuous improvement, and resilience

1.2. Restore economic opportunity and vibrancy in declining communities, including by:

1.2.1. Investing in place-based innovation and entrepreneurship to grow hubs of specialist economic activity that build on local assets and meet local needs, while mitigating adverse effects of clustering businesses;

1.2.2. Providing flexible funding, advice, and partnerships to support community-led approaches to community development, resilience, and revitalisation;

1.3. Support community economic resilience by:

1.3.1. Funding initiatives that keep local resources circulating locally, increase economic diversity, and minimise dependence on fossil fuels.

1.3.2. Undertaking adaptive community economic planning and mapping processes to proactively manage predicted changes in population, climate, energy, and the wider economy.

1.3.3. Mitigating the social and economic impacts of large-scale retail on local communities and small businesses

1.3.4. Enabling and nurturing community and social enterprises, through access to grant funding and capital and support for research, development, and training

1.3.5. Enabling communities to organise sustainable local economic infrastructure, such as farmers' and craft markets.

1.3.6. Enabling local currencies, community banks, credit unions, time banking schemes, and other local alternative economic systems

1.4. Support communities to rebuild and strengthen local social networks, including by:

1.4.1. Identifying emerging concerns, interests, and opportunities for connection amongst community members

1.4.2. Resourcing initiatives that reach out to isolated households, build community, and connect neighbours

2. Tangata Whenua, Community, and Voluntary Sector

Issues

Tangata whenua, along with community and volunteer organisations, form a wide network of diverse groups that collectively deliver vital services and activities that support and enhance cultural and social wellbeing. Increasing demand for their services, to meet growing needs, stretches already limited resources.

Actions

2.1. Ensure the Crown meets its Te Tiriti obligations in relation to the tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector, including by:

2.1.1. Supporting tangata whenua-led dialogue with the Crown on how the relationship should be developed.

2.1.2. Encouraging and resourcing community and voluntary organisations to develop Tiriti-based practice

2.1.3. Adopting flexible, culturally appropriate definitions of 'volunteering'.

2.1.4. Ensuring Māori can define which tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector organisations are entitled to receive kaupapa Māori funding.

2.1.5. Ensuring Māori maintain ownership over taonga created by Māori within tangata whenua, community and voluntary sector organisations, including intellectual property, regardless of Government funding.

2.2. Promote transparency, public trust, and confidence in the charitable sector, and safeguard the public interest, by:

2.2.1. Limiting the focus of the Charities Commission to registration and associated tax issues.

2.2.2. Implementing a Code of Practice for funding and contracting relationships with the sector that is developed and endorsed by tangata whenua, the sector and Government.

2.2.3. Regularly reviewing the limits on tax-deductible donations to registered charities.

2.2.4. In relation to accountability expectations:

2.2.4.1. Minimising monitoring and reporting requirements in direct relationship to the amount of money funded, and resource the costs of meeting them;

2.2.4.2. Setting realistic and flexible expectations and recognise outputs as the actual work done, including innovation;

2.2.4.3. Valuing a reflective and responsive approach;

2.2.4.4. Seeking regular independent review of funders' performance; and

2.2.4.5. Allowing and encourage sector organisations to develop their own evaluation methods, including social and environmental auditing and evaluation based on tikanga Māori.

2.2.4.6. Reducing tax compliance costs for not-for-profit organisations.

2.3. Enhance tangata whenua, community, and voluntary sector participation in policy and planning processes at all levels of Government, including by:

2.3.1. Strengthening the role, standing, and reach of the Minister for the Community and Voluntary Sector.

2.3.2. Resourcing sector-led initiatives for education and capacity building, including for public sector staff

2.3.3. Funding a sector-led group to work with local and central Government to build reciprocal relationships based on principles of empowerment, participation, and mutual respect

2.3.4. Increasing funding for research and development and policy creation carried out by the sector.

2.4. Support an independent tangata whenua, community, and voluntary sector by:

2.4.1. Requiring all Government departments and agencies to accept the right of the sector to advocate for those individuals, communities and issues in whose interests they work, without prejudice in regards to funding, contracting or tax status.

2.4.2. Increasing funding and infrastructure support available to the sector organisations that provide quality support and advocacy services for people dealing with Government departments.

2.4.3. Avoiding Government-led creation of NGOs

2.5. Ensure sustainable and equitable funding for the tangata whenua, community, and voluntary sector by:

2.5.1. Offering full and part funding options;

2.5.2. Funding an equitable share of overheads and capacity-building infrastructure;

2.5.3. Offering multi-year funding;

2.5.4. Avoiding unduly replicating existing organisations;

2.5.5. Increasing Community Organisations Grants Scheme (COGS) funding to a level that fully replaces funds from gambling sources